SYSTEMATIX GROUP™
Investments Re-defined

Systematix Weekly MacroMemos

24 November 2025

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Table of Contents

Assessment and Outlook: Trade weakness forebodes domestic fragility

Assessment and Outlook: Momentum of Eight Core Industries weaken

Data Release of the Week: India's Trade Performance (Oct'25)

Data Release of the Week: Performance of Eight Core Industries (Oct'25)

Monetary Trends

Market Data Snapshot

Domestic & Foreign Flows: Volatile FII's but DII remain supportive

Domestic News and Developments

Global News and Developments

Systematix Recent Macro and Strategy Notes

Assessment and Outlook (1/4): Trade weakness forebodes domestic fragility

India's merchandise trade deficit hit a record in October 2025, as surging imports, fueled by GST reductions and higher gold prices, far surpassed exports that contracted amid intense Chinese competition and muted domestic output. While services exports provided some support with a net surplus, they could not offset the sharp widening in the goods deficit. Meanwhile, India's Eight Core Industries stagnated, posting their weakest monthly performance in over a year as gains in sectors like fertilizers, steel, and refinery products were completely offset by energy segment declines, underscoring structural challenges for the economy. On the broader macro front, retail inflation has dipped to a multi-decade low, while industrial production growth remains anaemic at 3–4%. This points to continued slack in nominal GDP growth. Even as there is a general hope for the intense US-India trade deal reaching an outcome, the it will still be far restrictive compared to pre-Trump 2.0 levels. Additionally, competition from cheap Chinese imports continues to weigh on India's manufacturing revival.

India's merchandise trade deficit hit a record USD 41.7 bn in Oct'25 as initial upsurge in exports to the US is unwinding and imports rising in response to GST reduction attracting greater imports along with surge in gold prices. Services trade has seen an episodic upsurge, but not enough to take care of the rise in trade deficit. Consequently, in the backdrop of feeble capital inflows, the Indian rupee has seen renewed weakening to a record low of 88.7 to a dollar, notwithstanding RBI's interventions.

Assessment and Outlook (2/4): Trade weakness forebodes domestic fragility

Goods trade

Merchandise deficit widened to a record USD 41.7 bn in Oct'25, with import growth far outpacing exports amid intense Chinese competition and soft domestic production.

Exports contracted 11.8% YoY to USD 34.3 bn, while imports rose 17% YoY to USD 76 bn, reflecting the spillover effect of GST reduction

Non-oil non-gold imports rose 8.4% YTD (Apr–Oct FY26), up from 4.2% a year earlier, while non-oil exports slowed to 4.0% from 7.4%, indicating a weakening core export engine.

Precious metal imports

Gold and silver imports jumped to an all-time high of USD 14.4 bn in Oct'25, driven by higher global gold prices and strong investor preference amid weak returns from alternative assets.

Services trade

Services trade remained a key buffer, with exports rising 11.9% YoY to USD 38.5 bn and imports up 8.9% YoY to USD 18.6 bn in Oct'25.

The net services surplus increased 15.7% to USD 19.9 bn, partially cushioning the record goods

Assessment and Outlook (3/4): Momentum of Eight Core Industries weaken

October 2025 data reveals stark stagnation in India's Eight Core Industries, with no growth recorded, the weakest monthly performance in 14 months (since Aug'24's contraction). This flat performance contrasts sharply with Sep'25's revised 3.3% expansion, highlighting volatility and emerging headwinds. Cumulative growth for Apr-Oct FY26 slowed to 2.5%, down from 4.3% in the year-ago period, underscoring a broader deceleration in core sector momentum amid festive-season distortions and structural challenges.

The flat headline masks a polarized performance: gains in downstream and construction-linked sectors (fertilizers, steel, cement, refinery products) were fully offset by declines in primary energy segments (coal, crude oil, natural gas, electricity).

- **Coal (-8.5%):** Sharpest monthly drop, driven by mining disruptions and a high base from the prior year.
- **Crude Oil (-1.2%):** Steady contraction due to maturing fields and import reliance.
- **Refinery Products (+4.6%):** Rebound from early-year slump, aided by festive fuel demand.
- **Fertilizers (+7.4%):** Strongest gainer, fueled by subsidy-driven production and anticipation of the rabi sowing season.
- **Steel (+6.7%):** Supported by government infrastructure demand; slowed from Sep'25 double-digit growth due to base effects.

Assessment and Outlook (4/4): Momentum of Eight Core Industries weaken

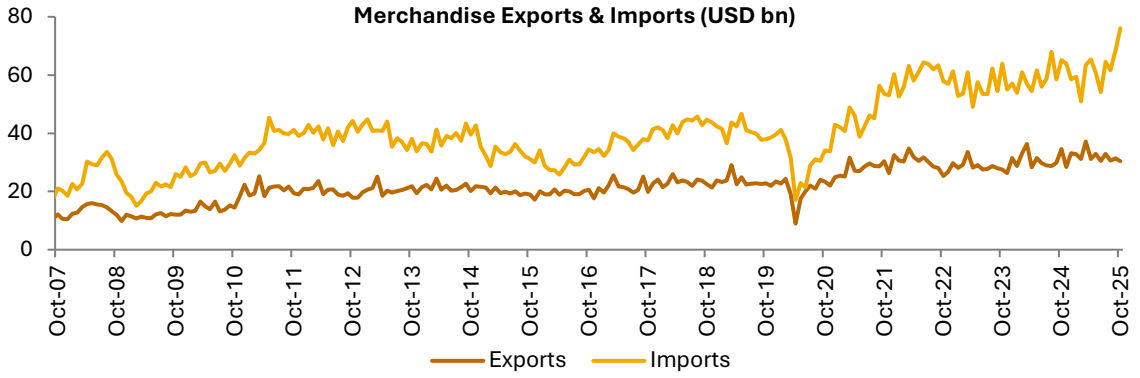
- **Cement (+5.3%):** In line with the government's frontloading of capex spending.
- **Electricity (-0.1%):** Marginal dip, attributed to weather variability and transmission bottlenecks.

As a 40% proxy for the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), October's stagnation foreshadows sub-4% industrial growth for Q3 FY26. Corporate results also indicate a lacklustre demand momentum in 2Q, with expectations of a turnaround in 2H FY26; however, signs of recovery remain elusive.

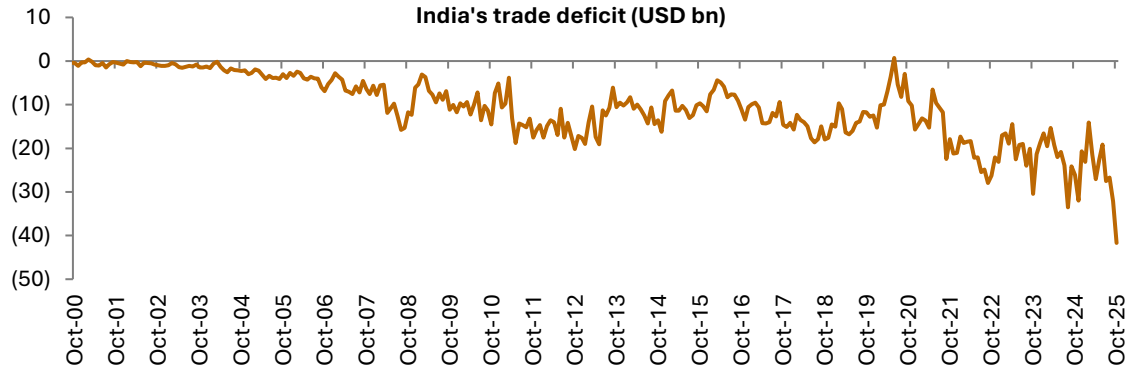
On the broader macro front, retail inflation has dipped to a multi-decade low, while industrial production growth remains anaemic at 3–4%. This points to continued slack in nominal GDP growth. Geopolitical tensions and China's continued dumping, as indicated in trade data, undercut exports, despite anti-dumping duties already in place for metals

Data Release of the Week (1/2): India's Trade Performance (Oct'25)

Imports (USD 76 bn) surged while the exports (USD 34 bn) remained flat...

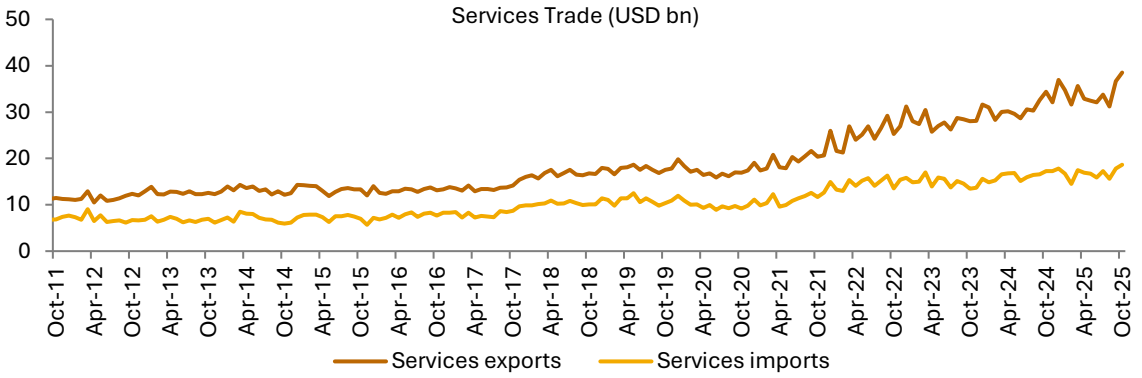


...widening the trade deficit to record levels of USD 41.7 bn



Non-oil & non-gold imports surged while flattish exports but gold and silver imports saw a steep surge

Both the services exports and imports surged to new highs



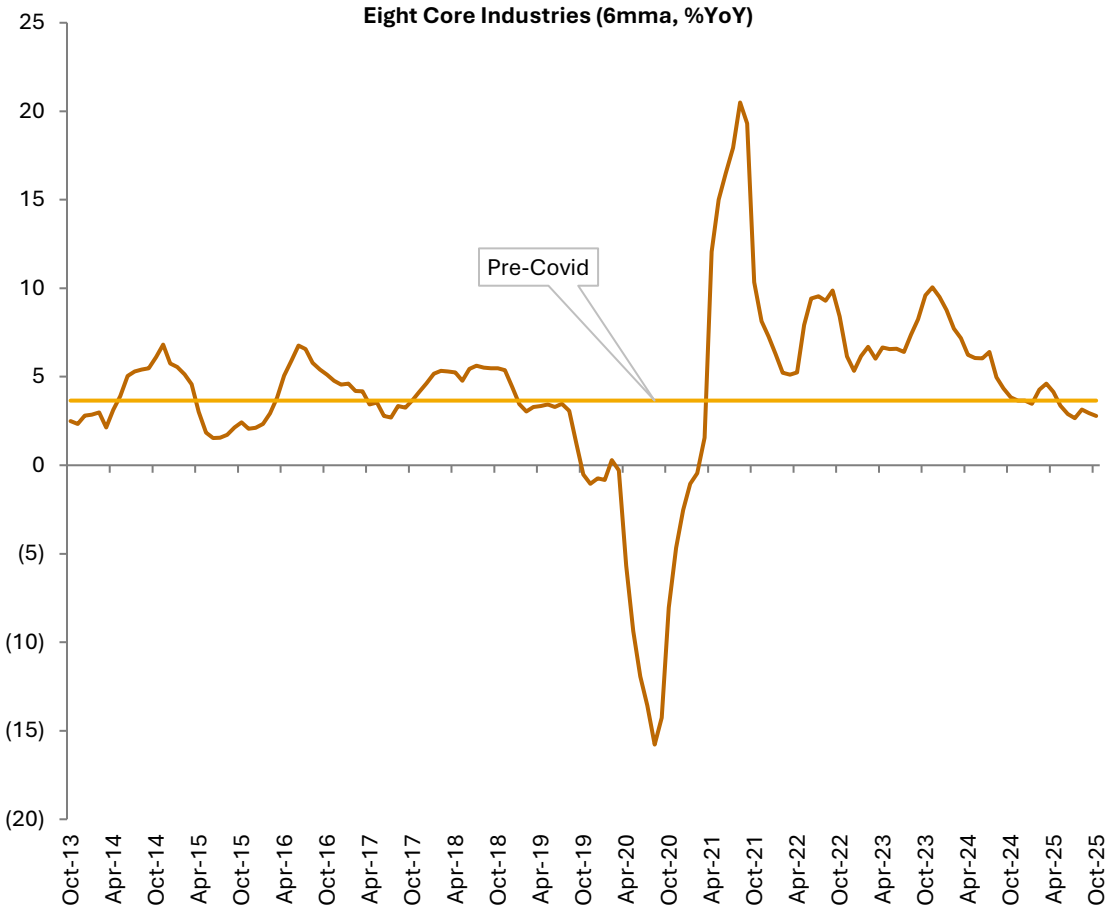
Source: CMIE, Systematix Research

Table of Contents

SYSTEMATIX GROUP™
Investments Re-defined

Data Release of the Week (2/2): Performance of Eight Core Industries (Oct'25)

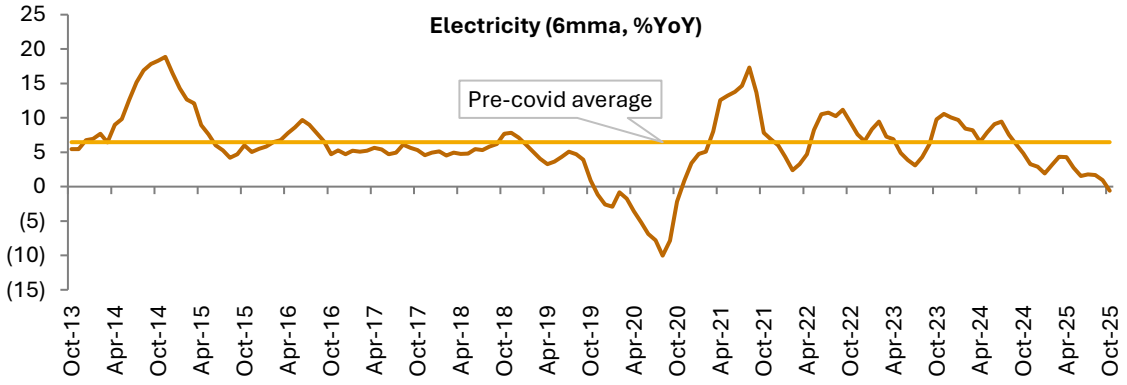
Index of eight core industries has recorded no growth in Oct'25 (YoY), marking the weakest performance in the last 14 months



In line with muted performance of overall manufacturing sector, core industries (except steel and cement) have recorded either contraction or muted growth in FYTD26

YoY (%)	Oct-24	Oct-25	Apr-Oct FY25	Apr-Oct FY26
Coal	7.8	-8.6	6.2	-2.0
Crude oil	-4.9	-1.2	-2.5	-1.0
Natural gas	-1.3	-5.1	1.5	-3.1
Refinery products	5.2	4.6	2.7	0.4
Fertilizers	0.4	7.4	1.5	0.7
Steel	**5.7**	**6.7**	**6.2**	**10.3**
Cement	**3.1**	**5.3**	**1.9**	**7.3**
Electricity	1.9	-7.6	5.4	-0.1
Eight Core Industries	**3.8**	**0**	**4.3**	**2.5**

Electricity generation and coal production (a crucial input for thermal power generation) recorded abysmally low growth rates of -7.6% and -8.5%, respectively, in Oct'25



Source: CMIE, Systematix Research

Table of Contents

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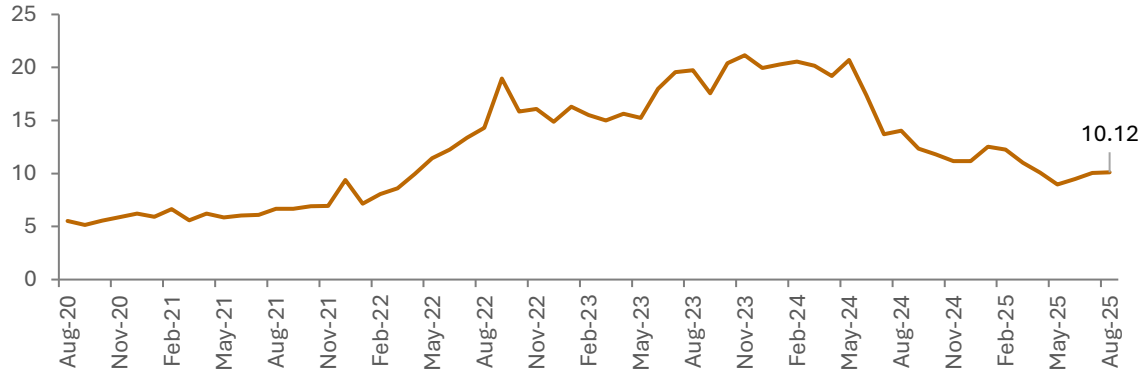
Monetary Trends

Deposits slow while credit growth rebounded, Rise in CD ratio and weakening INR have led to hardening of Gsec yields

Banking aggregates (% YoY)	01-Nov-24	03-Oct-25	31-Oct-25
Total Liabilities Ex HDFC	10.86		
Total liabilities	10.45	9.28	9.24
Deposits ex HDFC	12.22		
Deposits	11.75	9.94	9.74
Credit ex HDFC	13.19		
Credit	11.77	11.35	11.31
Non-Food Credit ex HDFC	13.16		
Non-Food Credit	11.75	11.33	11.10
Credit deposit ratio	77.27	79.95	80.21
Broad money (M3): Money supply	11.2	9.6	9.3
Reserve money (M0)	6.6	3.1	1.4

Source: CMIE, Systematix Research

Bank Credit (% YoY) have slowed down in the recent years indicating lacklustre demand in the economy



Weak bank deposit are mimicking stressed household income

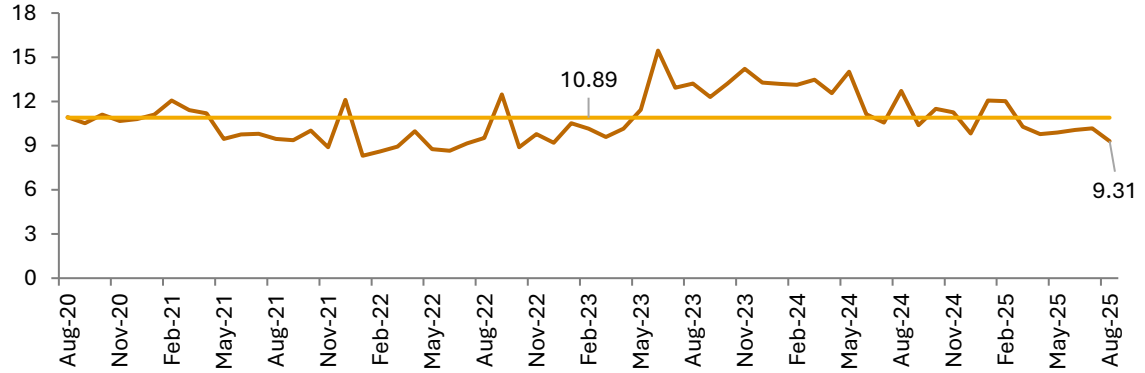


Table of Contents

SYSTEMATIX GROUP™
Investments Re-defined

Market Data Snapshot

Global Index Performance	Value	Weekly change (%)
Hang Seng	25,220.0	-5.09
Dow Jones	45,752.3	-3.59
NASDAQ	22,078.1	-3.46
Nikkei	48,625.9	-3.48
Shanghai	3,834.9	-3.90
Nifty 50	26,068.2	0.61
India Vix	13.6	14.18

Commodity Market	Value	Weekly change (%)
Brent	62.4	-3.15
WTI	57.9	-3.50
Gold	121,330.0	-2.70
Silver	150,740.0	-5.75
Copper	1,000.0	-1.57
Aluminium	265.0	-3.23
Zinc	310.5	-1.80

Currency Market	Value	Weekly change (%)
USD	89.41	-0.75
EUR	103.13	0.00
GBP	116.87	-0.12

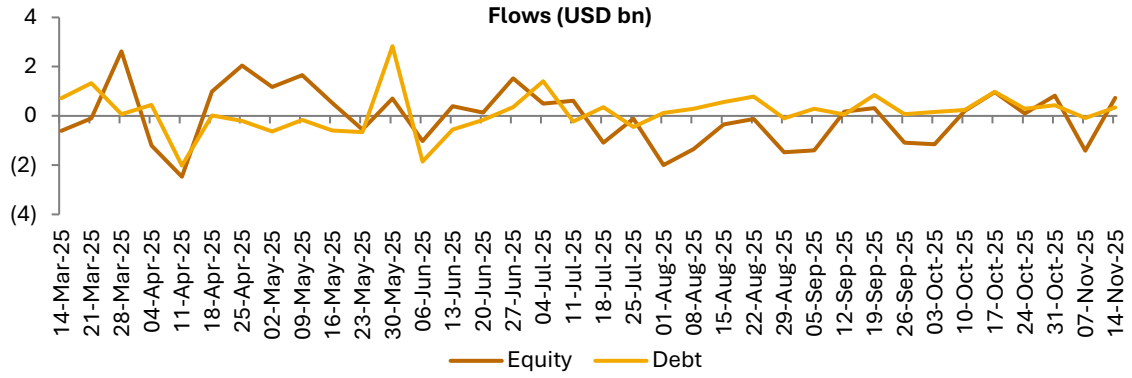
Money Market	Value	Weekly change (bps)
Call Money Rate	5.37	-0.03
91 day T-bills	5.43	-0.02
182 day T-bills	5.57	-0.02
364 day T-bills	5.57	-0.02
Commercial Paper	7.79	-2.57
Certificate of Deposit	6.07	-0.04
10 year G-Sec yield	6.53	0.02

Source: CMIE, Systematix Research

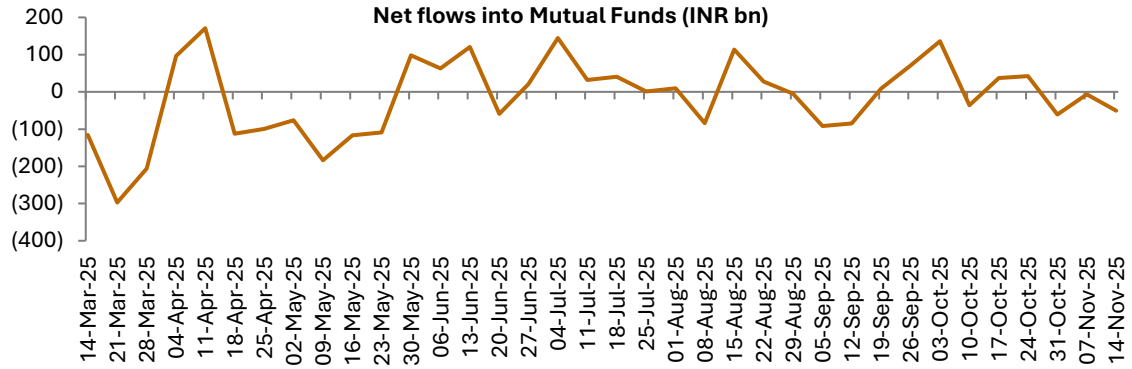
Table of Contents

Domestic & Foreign Flows: Volatile FII's but DII remain supportive

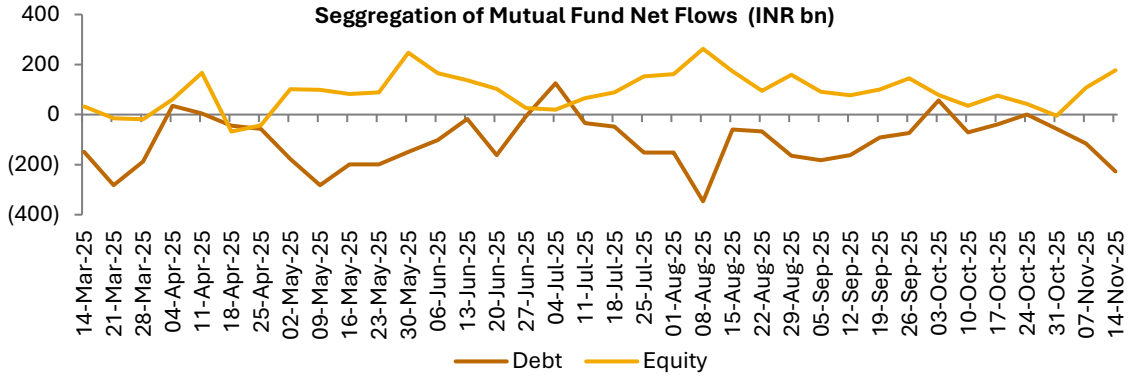
Total FII inflow, both in debt and equity of USD 1.3 bn in the past week



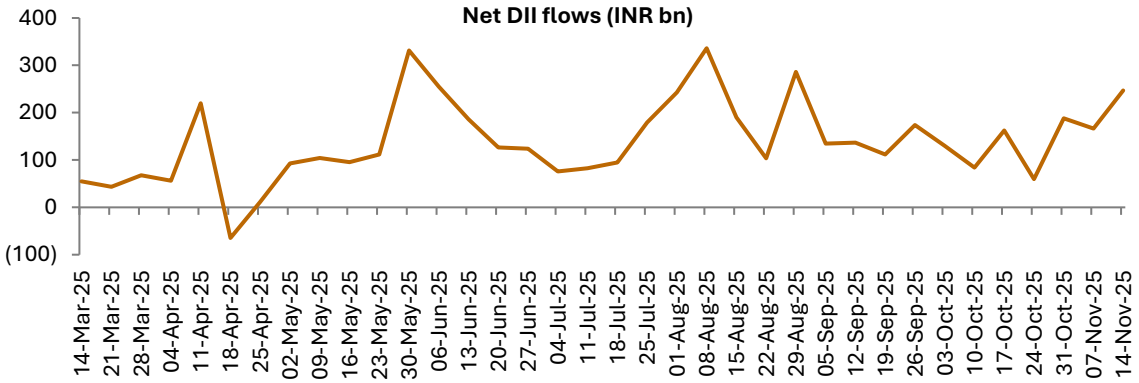
MF flows into equity remains high



Net MF flows in equity have been conducive, however, outflows continues for debt instruments



While the FII's retract from the Indian markets, DII remain supportive; highest ever net buying by them



Source: CMIE, Systematix Research

Table of Contents

SYSTEMATIX GROUP™
Investments Re-defined

Domestic News and Developments (1/3)

India Seeks Chipmaking Parity With Major Producers by 2032: India's semiconductor push is in early stages, with the country using a $10 billion fund to attract designers and manufacturers. Three of India's chip facilities will start commercial production early next year, according to Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw.

Indian Stocks Briefly Hit Record High on Earnings Optimism: India's benchmark stock index briefly surpassed its all-time high on Thursday before paring some gains, as investor sentiment toward local equities stayed upbeat amid reviving foreign inflows and improving corporate earnings. Overseas investors turned net buyers of local equities in October after three months of outflows, as confidence improved on the back of better earnings, lower consumption taxes and progress in trade talks with Washington.

INDIA PREVIEW: 3Q Growth to Slow on Weaker Taxes, Not Output: India's GDP growth likely lost steam in the July–September quarter as weaker indirect tax receipts and a services slowdown took a toll. Softer inflation lifted household purchasing power and lowered firms' input costs, while a good harvest boosted rural demand and tax cuts spurred production. GDP growth is set to slow further this quarter as indirect tax receipts weaken after GST rate cuts.

RBI Says Rupee to Steady Once India Clinches US Trade Deal: The recent currency depreciation stems from trade-related concerns and expectations that high tariffs could widen the trade deficit, according to Reserve Bank of India Governor Sanjay Malhotra. The central bank maintains a flexible inflation target of 2% to 6% because food makes up a large share of the Consumer Price Index basket, Malhotra said.

TCS Gets $1 Billion from TPG to Build Indian AI Data Centers: Tata Consultancy Services Ltd. secured $1 billion from TPG Inc. to speed its push into artificial intelligence data centers. TCS and TPG will invest as much as 180 billion rupees into the Indian IT firm's AI data center arm, HyperVault, over the next few years.

Domestic News and Developments (2/3)

India's Reliance Stops Using Russian Oil in Part of Jamnagar: The export-focused part of the refinery took its last shipment of Russian crude on Thursday, and the site could keep supplying fuel to Europe when new sanctions come into effect. Reliance isn't currently buying Russian oil and hasn't taken a view yet on whether it will resume doing so, but some previous purchases will discharge at another part of the Jamnagar facility.

Hype Around Small Nuclear is Overblown, Indian Official Says: A senior Indian nuclear department official says the hype around small modular reactors is overblown and advocates for building large-sized reactors to save on capital costs. Ravi B. Grover says that smaller reactors result in higher capital costs and power prices, and that India should build plants that are as large as possible to meet its growing requirement for clean electricity.

Billionaire-Backed IndusInd Plans Sweeping Overhaul After Probe: IndusInd Bank Ltd. is preparing a restructuring to boost profitability and clean up underperformance, according to Chief Executive Officer Rajiv Anand. The bank will channel more resources into artificial intelligence and expand its retail business to strengthen its balance sheet, Anand said.

Billionaire Family Turns India's Gold Obsession Into a Fortune: The Muthoot clan's family-run firm, Muthoot Finance Ltd., is benefiting from surging bullion prices as consumers take out gold loans, pushing the company's stock to a record and boosting the family's combined fortune. Gold lending across all firms in India surged 35% in the 12 months ended in June, with Muthoot Finance's outstanding gold loans rising to 1.25 trillion rupees at the end of September.

Rich Nations Must Hit Net Zero and Pay Up on Climate, India Says: Richer nations must move faster on zeroing out emissions and do more to mobilize funding to help developing economies meet climate targets, India's Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav told the COP30 summit in Brazil.

Domestic News and Developments (3/3)

India Seeks Trade Pact With SCO Nations to De-Risk Supply Chains: “We assess the global economic situation to be particularly uncertain and volatile currently,” Jaishankar added. India sees urgent need to de-risk and diversify its supply chains. The SCO has 10 member countries including China, India, Iran, Kazakhstan, Kyrgystan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan.

India May Lift Ethanol Price to Help Sugar Mills With High Costs: India is considering an increase to the prices of ethanol used for gasoline blending, a move that should help sugar mills absorb higher cane costs and ensure timely payments to farmers, according to a person familiar with the matter.

Jefferies Hires Mizuho Banker to Lead Private Debt in India: Jefferies Financial Group Inc. hired a banker from Mizuho Financial Group Inc. to lead its private credit advisory business in India. Global investment funds are driving the boom in India's private credit market, with the market contributing to many large transactions amid an infrastructure push by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

VW Pares India EV Development Costs Amid Hunt for A Partner: Volkswagen AG is slashing costs of developing electric vehicles in India by a third and scouting for a local partner to help boost its market share. Volkswagen is weighing short-term options, including EV imports, as India’s tighter local carbon-emission norms are kicking in from 2027, making it critical for carmakers to switch to cleaner technologies.

RBI’s Big Inflation Misses Put India’s Forecasts Under Scrutiny: The Reserve Bank of India's inflation forecasting model is under scrutiny after the central bank overestimated price pressures this year. Economists predict another big miss in the current quarter after a low inflation print in October, which may mean the RBI's projection of 2.6% for the fiscal year is out of date. The RBI's overestimation of inflation may have led to unnecessarily hawkish policy, with some economists expecting the central bank to cut interest rates in December to boost the economy.

Global News and Developments (1/3)

Japan Is Set to Unveil Largest Spending Plan Since Pandemic Era: The total value of the package will be worth ¥21.3 trillion, and the impact of the package overall is expected to balloon to around ¥42.8 trillion with private sector spending. The increase in outlays is set to add to Japan's debt burden, with general government debt expected to be equivalent to 230% of its economy this year, according to the International Monetary Fund.

A Hedge Against AI Crash Emerges as Oracle CDS Market Explodes: Oracle Corp. is emerging as the credit market's barometer for AI risk due to its massive AI-related spending spree and weaker credit grades. The price to protect against the company defaulting on its debt for five years has tripled in recent months to as high as 1.11 percentage point a year. Oracle's shares have lost about a third of their value from Sept. 10 through Wednesday's close, reflecting investors' growing concern about the company's AI investments.

Xi Risks Global Blowback If China Curbs Rare Earths to Japan: China has punished Japan for Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi's remarks on Taiwan, but has not used rare earths as a lever against Japan. Beijing's moves so far appear calibrated to inflict pain without crossing into territory that might galvanize a coordinated international response, with actions including halting seafood imports and cautioning tourists.

Wall Street Stunned as Reversal in S&P 500 Erases $2.7 Trillion: The US stock market experienced its most dramatic intraday reversal since April, with benchmark indexes falling to their lowest levels in more than two months. Theories for the selloff included concerns about artificial-intelligence projects, a strong jobs report, and a drop in Bitcoin to a six-month low, as well as worries about lofty stock valuations and an uptick in volatility.

Global News and Developments (2/3)

Japan's October Data Keep BOJ on Track for Gradual Rate Hikes: Consumer prices excluding fresh food rose 3% from a year earlier, with rising costs for hotels, car insurance premiums and household durable goods exerting upward pressure. Japan's exports rose for a second month as a weaker yen inflated their value, while shipments to the US continued to slide lower due to tariffs.

Russian Oil Risks Being Stranded as US Sanctions Take Effect: US sanctions could leave nearly 48 million barrels of Russian crude stranded on the water, with dozens of tankers scrambling for alternative destinations. Indian refiners are seeking replacement supplies, booking oil tankers for cargoes from the Middle East, as traders monitor the ultimate buyers for Lukoil and Rosneft crude already at sea.

Asia's Currency-Defense War Chest Has Swelled to $8 Trillion: Asia's foreign-exchange reserves have surged to almost $8 trillion, providing authorities with ample ammunition to defend their currencies. The major central banks in the region have added more than $400 billion to their reserves this year, helped by the decline in the dollar and rally in gold prices. Central bank intervention is back on the radar in Asia as heightened volatility in global equity markets has led to a rebound in the dollar and broad weakness across regional exchange rates.

US Warns South Africa Not to Issue G-20 Statement at Summit: The US opposes South Africa's G-20 presidency and its core agenda of solidarity, equality and sustainability, and will block any outcome framed as a consensus G-20 position. Despite the US opposition, South Africa is pressing ahead with efforts to obtain a joint statement at the summit, with support from countries such as Brazil and Germany.

Citadel Securities Launches AI Bond Trading Baskets for Hedging: Citadel Securities LLC started making markets for two baskets of corporate bonds issued by Microsoft Corp., Amazon.com Inc., Alphabet Inc. and Meta Platforms Inc. on Wednesday.

Global News and Developments (3/3)

Trump Gets a Cold Shoulder From GOP Lawmakers Over Tariff Checks: Republican lawmakers are resisting President Donald Trump's proposal to send $2,000 checks to working-class households next year. The White House says the checks would be funded by tariff revenue, but lawmakers prefer to use the revenue to reduce the deficit.

Fed Minutes Show 'Many' Officials Lean Against December Cut: Many Federal Reserve officials said it would likely be appropriate to keep interest rates steady for the remainder of 2025. Several policymakers were against lowering the Fed's benchmark rate at the October 28-29 meeting, and several participants said another cut in December could well be appropriate if the economy evolved about as they expected.

Market Euphoria Ends for Takaichi as Yen and Bonds Sink: Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi is facing her first major market test as concerns over the government's impending stimulus package threaten to derail the rally her election helped ignite. Takaichi's administration is expected to unveil its economic package on Friday, which may worsen Japan's fiscal health and prompt a "sell Japan" trade, with investors watching for signs of policy error and potential intervention.

Nvidia's Upbeat Forecast Soothes Fears of AI Spending Bubble: Nvidia Corp. delivered a strong revenue forecast, expecting sales of about $65 billion in the January quarter, and pushed back on the idea that the AI industry is in a bubble. Nvidia's results topped analysts' estimates, with revenue rising 62% to $57 billion in the third quarter, and the company's market value is at $4.5 trillion, with shares gaining 39% this year through the close.

White House Asks Congress to Reject Bill Curbing Nvidia Exports: White House officials are urging members of Congress to oppose the GAIN AI Act, which would limit Nvidia Corp.'s ability to sell AI chips to China and other adversary nations. The GAIN AI Act would create a system that requires chipmakers to give US companies first dibs on AI chips that are controlled for export to China and other arms-embargoed countries.

Systematix Recent Macro and Strategy Notes

- *India's Policy Response to Global Fragmentation Deserves Fresh Thinking*
- *RBI's 'insularity' stance contrasts with reality and actions*
- *Trump's H-1B Firewall Expands US Protectionism Against India*
- *Household situation tracker: Tentative signs of revival*
- *RBI's Private Capex Revival Guidance: Hope or Overstatement?*
- *GST Rate Cuts Can Lift Demand, But Fiscal Balancing Will Be Key*
- *S&P India Rating Upgrade: Overriding Glaring Macro Challenges*
- *RBI Acknowledges Limitations of Policy Easing*
- *A short history of MNREGA: 20 years in 10 charts*
- *Trump's stridency with India precludes TACO trade!!*

Disclosures/Appendix (1/2)

I. ANALYST CERTIFICATION

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Disclosure of Interest Statement	Update
Analyst holding in the stock	No
Served as an officer, director or employee	No

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10. There is no material disciplinary action taken by any regulatory authority that impacts the equity research analysis activities.

STOCK RATINGS

BUY (B): The stock's total return is expected to exceed 15% over the next 12 months.

HOLD (H): The stock's total return is expected to be within -15% to +15% over the next 12 months.

SELL (S): The stock's total return is expected to give negative returns of more than 15% over the next 12 months.

NOT RATED (NR): The analyst has no recommendation on the stock under review.

INDUSTRY VIEWS

ATTRACTIVE (AT): Fundamentals/valuations of the sector are expected to be attractive over the next 12-18 months.

NEUTRAL (NL): Fundamentals/valuations of the sector are expected to neither improve nor deteriorate over the next 12-18 months.

CAUTIOUS (CS): Fundamentals/valuations of the sector are expected to deteriorate over the next 12-18 months.

Disclosures/Appendix (2/2)

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